

STATE OF NEW YORK

5605--D

2025-2026 Regular Sessions

IN SENATE

February 25, 2025

Introduced by Sens. KAVANAGH, FERNANDEZ, MAY -- read twice and ordered printed, and when printed to be committed to the Committee on Consumer Protection -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee -- recommitted to the Committee on Consumer Protection in accordance with Senate Rule 6, sec. 8 -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee

AN ACT to amend the general business law, in relation to enacting the "washing machine microfiber filtration act"

The People of the State of New York, represented in Senate and Assembly, do enact as follows:

1 Section 1. This act shall be known and may be cited as the "washing
2 machine microfiber filtration act".

3 § 2. The general business law is amended by adding a new section 396-
4 uu to read as follows:

5 § 396-uu. Sale of washing machines; microfiber filtration. 1. Defi-
6 nitions. As used in this section, the following terms shall have the
7 following meanings:

8 a. "Microfiber filtration system" means a filter or other feature, or
9 a series of filters or other features, built into a washing machine or
10 packaged, sold, and installed with a washing machine that removes from
11 water used across all washing cycles ninety percent or more of fibers
12 and microfibers that are one hundred micrometers or larger.

13 b. "Washing machine" means a machine designed and used for washing
14 clothes and linen.

15 2. a. On and after January first, two thousand thirty, no new washing
16 machines shall be offered for sale or sold in the state without a micro-
17 fiber filtration system.

EXPLANATION--Matter in italics (underscored) is new; matter in brackets
[-] is old law to be omitted.

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1 b. All new washing machines sold for residential use in the state with
2 a microfiber filtration system on or after January first, two thousand
3 thirty shall bear a conspicuous sticker or other label that is visible
4 to the consumer and that includes the following statement: "Notice: This
5 washing machine includes a filtration system to capture microfibers."
6 Such statement shall be followed by instructions regarding the manner
7 and frequency with which the consumer should check the system's filters
8 or other features and dispose of any fibers or microfibers captured.

9 c. All new washing machines sold for commercial use in the state with
10 a microfiber filtration system on or after January first, two thousand
11 thirty shall contain the sticker or other label described in paragraph b
12 of this subdivision, however such sticker or other label may be placed
13 in a location that is not visible to users of such commercial washing
14 machine.

15 3. a. A manufacturer of a washing machine that is subject to the
16 requirements of subdivision two of this section shall provide each
17 person that offers such washing machine for sale or distribution in the
18 state with a certificate of compliance stating that the washing machine
19 is in compliance with the requirements of this section and contains a
20 microfiber filtration system. A certificate of compliance provided
21 pursuant to this subdivision shall be signed by an authorized official
22 of the manufacturer. The certificate of compliance may be provided elec-
23 tronically.

24 b. A distributor or retailer of a washing machine that is subject to
25 the requirements of this section shall not be held in violation of this
26 section if the distributor or retailer is not also the manufacturer of
27 the washing machine and relied in good faith on the certificate of
28 compliance provided by the manufacturer pursuant to paragraph a of this
29 subdivision.

30 4. The department of environmental conservation may adopt any rules or
31 regulations it deems necessary for the implementation of the provisions
32 of this section, including standards and procedures for determining
33 whether a washing machine is compliant with the provisions of this
34 section.

35 5. Upon an action brought by the attorney general, a city attorney, a
36 county counsel, or a district attorney, a person or entity that violates
37 this section shall be liable for a civil penalty not to exceed five
38 hundred dollars for the first violation, and not to exceed one thousand
39 dollars for each subsequent violation.

40 § 3. This act shall take effect immediately.